

Name: _____

Date: _____

How Do Koalas Live?

Year 3 reading comprehension · Information text · 13 marks · About 15 minutes

Meet the koala

Koalas live in the eucalyptus forests of eastern Australia. They look like small bears, but they are not bears at all. A koala is a marsupial, which means it carries its baby in a pouch, just like a kangaroo.

Sleepy eaters

Koalas eat the leaves of eucalyptus trees. These leaves are tough and do not give much energy. Because of this, koalas sleep for about 18 to 22 hours every day. They rest in the fork of a tree and wake up mostly at night to feed. Sharp claws and strong arms help a koala grip the trunk. A koala also drinks very little, because it gets much of its water from the leaves it eats.

Baby koalas

A baby koala is called a joey. When it is born, it is tiny, about the size of a jellybean, and it crawls into its mother's pouch. It stays there for about six months. After that, the joey rides on its mother's back and clings to her fur while she climbs.

Staying safe

In some places, koalas are in danger because forests are being cut down and bushfires destroy their homes. Many people work to protect koalas by planting trees and caring for hurt animals in wildlife hospitals.

1. Where do koalas live? (1 mark)

2. What is a marsupial, according to the text? (1 mark)

3. What is a joey, according to the text? (1 mark)

4. Why do koalas sleep for so many hours every day? Use the text to explain. (2 marks)

5. Number these events 1 to 3 in the order they happen. (2 marks)

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The joey rides on its mother's back.

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The joey is born and crawls into its mother's pouch.

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The joey stays in the pouch for about six months.

6. The text says koalas “look like small bears, but they are not bears at all.” What does this tell you about why some people call them bears? (2 marks)

7. Why do you think planting trees helps koalas? (2 marks)

8. Write one sentence that tells the main idea of the whole text. (2 marks)

Writing task: Imagine you are a joey riding on your mother's back. Write about what you see and hear.
